- The receptionist is used within an actor to find other actors that have not been spawned by this actor or passed by a message or initialization.
- Pool and group routers are built into Akka and can use multiple strategies to deliver to their routees. Pool routers spawn their own routees, while group routers do not and use the receptionist to find them.
- The available strategies are random, round-robin, consistent hashing, and broadcasting. Round-robin is a fair distribution: each routee gets a message until they all have one, and then the distribution starts over. Consistent hashing uses a hashing algorithm to deterministically forward messages to routees; this approach is useful when routees come and go. Broadcasting uses a predicate, and each message is sent to every routee that matches that predicate.
- You can use a simple actor to implement routers that route based on content, using pattern matching for the messages, or based on the state of the actor, by specifying the next behavior.